

Surveillance System Policy

[Organization Name] | Version 1.0 | Effective date: [DD/MM/YYYY]

1. Purpose

This policy governs the installation, operation, and use of surveillance systems at [Organization Name] to protect people and property, deter and investigate incidents, and comply with the law, while respecting individual privacy.

2. Scope

It applies to all CCTV cameras, access-control and video-recording systems, and the footage they produce. It covers all employees, students, contractors, and visitors on [premises].

3. Principles

- **Legitimate purpose:** Surveillance is used only for security, safety, and incident investigation.
- **Proportionality:** Cameras are placed only where a real security need exists.
- **Transparency:** People are told they are being recorded.
- **Data minimization:** Only necessary footage is captured and kept.
- **Accountability:** Every access to footage is authorized and logged.

4. Camera Placement

- **Permitted:** entrances and exits, parking areas, corridors, server rooms, cash-handling areas, and perimeters.
- **Prohibited:** restrooms, changing rooms, medical rooms, and any area where people have a reasonable expectation of privacy.
- Placement changes require written approval from [Security Head / IT Head].

5. Notice

Visible signs at entrances and monitored zones must state that video surveillance is in operation, its purpose, and who to contact with questions.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Policy Owner ([Title])	Approves the policy, placement, and access rights
System Administrator	Maintains the system, access controls, backups, and logs
Security Staff	Monitor live feeds and report incidents
Data Protection Officer / Compliance	Handles privacy requests and audits

7. Access to Footage

- Access is limited to authorized personnel on a need-to-know basis.
- Each access, review, or export is logged with the date, person, and reason.
- Footage is disclosed to outside parties, such as police, only on a valid legal request or written authorization from [Policy Owner].
- Copying or sharing footage on personal devices or social media is prohibited.

8. Data Retention and Deletion

- Routine footage is kept for [30] days, then automatically overwritten or deleted.
- Footage relevant to an incident or investigation is preserved until the matter is closed, then deleted.
- Exported footage is stored encrypted and deleted when no longer needed.

9. Security of the System

- Strong, unique passwords and multi-factor authentication for admin accounts.
- Network isolation of cameras and recorders, with regular firmware and security updates.
- Recorders kept in locked, access-controlled rooms.
- Audit logs reviewed at least [quarterly].

10. Individual Rights

Individuals may request access to footage of themselves, subject to the privacy of others shown in it. Requests go to [contact email] and are answered within [30] days.

11. Audio and Special Technologies

Audio recording, facial recognition, and behavioral analytics are **not** permitted unless separately approved in writing after a privacy impact assessment.

12. Breaches and Misuse

Misuse of the system, unauthorized access, or disclosure of footage is a disciplinary offense and may lead to termination or legal action. Suspected breaches must be reported to [contact] immediately.

13. Monitoring and Review

This policy is reviewed at least annually, and after any major incident or change in law.

14. Legal Compliance

The system must comply with applicable data protection and privacy laws in your jurisdiction, such as India's DPDP Act 2023, GDPR, or local CCTV regulations.

This is a general template, not legal advice. Have it reviewed against local law before adopting it.

Approved by: _____

Date: _____